

LESSON 15

MEMORANDUMS, MEETING DOCUMENTS AND PROPOSALS

Outline

- Memorandum
 - Sample of Business Memo
- Minutes of Meeting
 - Types of Meeting Minutes
- Proposal
 - General Structure of Business Proposal

Memorandum

Memorandum is brief, informal report used to establish a record. Memos generalize the communication process by transmitting the message from one or more authors to one or more recipients. E-mail messages typically take the form of memoranda.

Memoranda are written for numerous internal purposes—for example, to request information, to make announcements, to outline policies, and to transmit meeting minutes.

The Memorandum Body

Generally, the topics of the memorandum are organized in order of importance, with the key statements first, and the details further on. The memorandum should normally begin with a brief summary statement, in one or two sentences, identifying the key topic and the scope of the memorandum.

Sample Memo Format / Template

TO:

FROM:

DATE:

SUBJECT:

First Sentence

Reason for the memo

Second Sentence - Main Body

Any Instruction or information

Closing Sentence

What is required of the reader e.g. confirmation, answers or feedback

Meeting Documents

Use meeting documents as tools to encourage productive and efficient meetings. The two principal meeting documents are the *agenda*, which tells participants about the topics that will be discussed at the meeting, and *minutes*, which record what actually occurred.

Agenda

An agenda is a simple list of topics to be discussed (in order of listing), along with the names of individuals who have agreed to lead discussion of those topics. An agenda helps focus a meeting on the core topics, allows you to control the pace and flow of a meeting, and identify important items to be acted upon. Meetings without published agendas generally seem unfocused and unproductive.

Example

Development Team Agenda

1. Report by Mr. Hamid on investigation of possible security software
2. Report by Ms. Sara on development of database prototypes
3. Discussion of possible hardware platforms
4. Review of deadlines for project
5. Agenda for next meeting

Minutes

Minutes, also known as protocols, are the written record of meetings, particularly of Boards of Directors and/or Shareholders of corporations, kept by the secretary of the corporation or organization. They often give an overview of the structure of the meeting, starting with a list of those present, a statement of the various issues before the participants, and each of their responses thereto. They are often created at the moment of the hearing by a typist or court recorder at the meeting, who may record the meeting in shorthand, and then prepare the minutes and issue them to the participants afterwards. Alternatively, the meeting may be audio recorded or notes taken, and the minutes prepared later. However, it is often important for the minutes to be brief and concentrate on material issues rather than being a verbatim report, so the minute-taker should have sufficient understanding of the subject matter to achieve this goal. The minutes of certain entities, such as a corporate board of directors, must be kept and are important legal documents.

Types of Minutes of Meeting

Minutes can be formal or informal. Formal minutes are often required by federal state, or local law, by-laws, charters, or regulations. They are usually distributed to the members of the group before the next meeting, and then approved (sometimes after being amended).

Sample of Meeting Minute

Please view the following links for the sample:

<http://managementhelp.org/boards/minutes.htm>

<http://www.slideshare.net/arlene5162/sample-1175115>

Proposals

A formal written document soliciting business and spelling out what will be delivered, the costs, terms, conditions, and so forth.

The aim of a 'business proposal' is to establish a working relationship to make it happen. It's a way of saying, "I have an idea, I can solve your problem. Let's make it happen together." It also persuades a potential customer to purchase goods or services, or to persuade your employer to fund a project or to implement a program that you would like to launch. A proposal should contain necessary information about the services and products offered. It would enable the

recipient of that proposal to decide whether to approve the project or not. Your proposal must state WHAT you are proposing, HOW you plan to do it, WHEN you plan to do it, and HOW MUCH it is going to cost.

Most organizations rely on successful proposal writing for their continued existence. You will most likely spend a major part of your professional life writing proposals.

General Structure

Learn the basic structure of a proposal. Proposals share a general document architecture, which is usually modified to suit specific circumstances.

The overall structure of a proposal can be broken down into following parts:

Proposal Structure

- Front matter
- Body
- Introduction
- Technical approach
- Management requirements
- Work plan
- End matter

- **Front Matter**

The front matter of a proposal includes the following components:

- Letter of transmittal
- Title page
- Summary
- Table of contents
- List of figures and tables

- **Body**

In the introduction to a proposal, do the following:

- Identify the motivating need or problem.
- Develop the immediate context in which this problem has been highlighted.

In external proposals, be sure you are responding to the published need and motivation as identified by the outside agency.

- **End Matter**

- Bibliography
- Résumés
- Appendixes

For sample 'Business Proposal' templates, please view the following links

<http://www.klariti.com/templates/Proposal-Template.shtml>

<http://www.scribd.com/doc/244716/sample-business-proposal>

<http://www.writinghelptools.com/proposal-sample.html>